

# How to Use Your Quarterly Estimated Tax Calculator

SKU TAX-005 · QUARTERLY ESTIMATED TAX CALCULATOR

Tracks YTD income/expenses by IRS quarter and tells you what to send each quarter — before April, when the year is already over.

**Important:** IRS quarters are NOT calendar quarters. Q1 = Jan–Mar 31 · Q2 = Apr–May 31 · Q3 = Jun–Aug 31 · Q4 = Sep–Dec 31.

## First-time setup (5 min)

1. Open tab **Settings**:
  - B5 → active tax year (e.g., 2026)
  - Filing status (Single / MFJ / HoH / MFS) — drives bracket math
  - Prior-year AGI + prior-year total tax — drives safe-harbor calc
  - Schedule classification (E or C) — drives whether SE tax applies
  - Spouse W-2 withholding (if applicable)
2. Update brackets if needed (workbook ships with 2026 single + MFJ).

## Every payment cycle (4× per year)

1. Open tab **Quarterly P&L**. Update the column for the current quarter:
  - Income lines (rents, cleaning fees collected, other, refunds)
  - Expense lines (~15 Schedule E/C categories)
2. Open tab **Estimated Tax**. Workbook computes:
  - **Annualized estimate** based on YTD profit
  - **Safe-harbor** = prior-year tax × 100% (or 110% if prior AGI > \$150K)
  - **Required quarterly payment** = MIN of the two methods, divided across remaining quarters
3. Open tab **Payment Schedule**. Mark the voucher Paid Y/N + method (EFTPS / DirectPay / mail).

## Reading the outputs

- **Cumulative cushion** — your payments minus your required-to-date. Negative is bad (penalty risk).
- **Underpayment-risk flag** — fires red if YTD paid is below YTD required.

## Voucher due dates (2026)

- Q1 → April 15, 2026
- Q2 → June 15, 2026
- Q3 → September 15, 2026
- Q4 → January 15, 2027

## At year-end

Hand the **Payment Schedule** tab to your CPA. They'll cross-check against your 1040 total tax and confirm no underpayment penalty.

## Questions?

**hello@thestrledger.com** — real humans, fast replies.

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**Upgrade path:** Tax Season Bundle (\$147) at [thestrledger.com/tax-bundle](https://thestrledger.com/tax-bundle) — Schedule E + Schedule C + Mileage + 1099 + Home Office + Section 179 + Quarterly Estimateds + Per-Diem.

Get on our list at **[thestrledger.com/47](https://thestrledger.com/47)** for our free "47 Airbnb Tax Deductions Most Hosts Miss" guide.

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